



Homemade Nuclear Reactor

A Swedish man was arrested for trying to build a nuclear reactor in his basement!
<http://bit.ly/p50hLf>



Student satellite launched

Kedr, a Russian satellite created by Russian students was launched to commemorate Yuri Gagarin's maiden space flight. <http://bit.ly/oREZZV>

Bazaar

AMD A8-3850 APU

Integrated graphics finally come of age

AMD's answer to the Intel Sandy Bridge processors has arrived with the launch of the Llano APU A8-3850 which is a quad core CPU clocked at 2.9 GHz with HD 6550D integrated graphics on board. The graphics solution has 400 stream processors. Just like the Sandy Bridge processors, AMD has also got the PCIe controllers, memory controllers on the processor die itself. In case of A8 3850, the Turbo Core technology (ability to increase clock rate dynamically) is not supported and the multiplier is locked at 29x.

The integrated graphics on the A8-3850 can be teamed up with discrete graphics and used in the

CrossFire mode. Right now only HD 6670, HD 6570, HD 6450 and HD 6350 cards are compatible.

We tested the board on Giga-byte A75M-UD2H board with 2 x 2GB Kingston HyperX DDR3 RAM at 1333MHz without any discrete card. PC Mark Vantage scored 7817 whereas CineBench R11.5 gave 3.39.

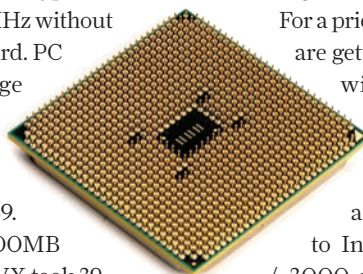
Encoding a 100MB VOB file to DIVX took 39 secs. Gaming is what impressed us, with Resident Evil 5 (RE 5) giving 44 FPS on 1680x1050, med setting and STALKER COP giving 32.7 FPS on 1280x1024, med setting. Crysis Warhead was not that impressive with 15 FPS at

1280x1024, med setting.

We paired the APU with Powercolor HD 6670 and enabled CrossFire mode. STALKER COP gave 46.8 FPS at 1680x1050, med and RE 5 gave 66 FPS.

For a price of ₹7,000, you are getting a processor with integrated graphics which are really good as compared to Intel's HD 2000 / 3000 when it comes to gaming. Right now the A8-3850 is recommended for those who want decent gaming on integrated graphics or those looking at building an HTPC with a decent gaming option.

Nimish Sawant



Specifications

Clock Speed: 2.9 GHz;
Turbo Core: No; **L2 Cache:** 4MB; **Integrated Graphics:** HD 6550D; **GPU clock:** 600 MHz; **TDP:** 100W

Contact

AMD India
Email: fusion.india@amd.com
Website: www.amd.com
Price: ₹7,000

7.0
10

Features.....7.0
Performance.....7.0
Build QualityNA
Value for Money7.0

Specifications

Media streaming device; works with up to 1080p HD video sources; 1 component, 1 composite and 1 S-video in and 1 each for video out; Coaxial audio pass-through; LAN connectivity; works with Windows and Mac PCs; No monthly rental; Mobile apps for Android, iOS and Windows Phone

Contact

Sling Media Pvt. Ltd.

Email: <http://www.slingmedia.com/go/contact>

Price: ₹14,999

7.0
10

Features.....7.0
Performance.....7.5
Build Quality7.5
Value for Money6.0

Slingbox PRO-HD

Interesting concept, good implementation

The trapezoidal design gives the Slingbox PRO-HD a pretty big footprint. The very purpose of this device is to stream video content from a device like a DTH set top box or even a DVD player, to your laptop or smartphone. The Slingbox PRO-HD is capable of doing 1080i HD video streaming over a network. What the Slingbox PRO-HD misses out on is HDMI input and wireless LAN capabilities.

You need to go to <http://in.slingbox.com/> to setup the PRO-HD. An account needs to be created, and this process is a tad annoying. While this works on Internet

Explorer and Mozilla Firefox, this refused to work on Google Chrome. Post the account sign-up and login, allows the PRO-HD to be detected. We did face the issue that the device wasn't detected the first couple of times. First off, we connected the Tata Sky HD set top box via the Component cable. We were surprised by the quality offered, when we were viewing on a laptop - it's pretty good. Once the video begins, you can also open up the remote for the device connected to it. The Tata Sky HD remote

that popped up looked exactly the same as the actual remote! Impressive attention to detail, we must say.

The Slingbox Pro-HD is a very interesting concept and a unique device aimed at what is currently a very niche market, but one that has the potential to grow given its abilities. The streaming from the connected devices (STB, DVD player, etc.) is absolutely flawless, even for HD content assuming your Internet connection is up to the task.

The ability to watch content streamed from somewhere, anywhere is a novel feature, but so is the price tag (₹15000).

Visbal Mathur

